

DIGITAL CONSTRUCTION OPERATING SYSTEM

Project Setup

Training Summary for Users & Clients

How a project is created, awarded, controlled and closed inside one platform — and what each role must do.

Module 04-02

Foundation Phase

Document R1

Project Setup is the front door of the platform

Every task, drawing, purchase order, inspection and payment in DCOS must belong to a project created here. Get this module right and the rest of the system stays clean; get it wrong and every downstream module inherits the mess.

1

entry gate

No WBS, task, document or PR can exist without a project

11

project statuses

One controlled lifecycle from tender to archive

10

working days

Target from Letter of Award to a fully active project

4

blocking items

Must be complete before a project can go live

“Replace spreadsheets and chat groups with one controlled registry.”

Four training tracks — take only what your role needs

A

Company Admin & Project Director

2.5 hours

Create projects, approve status changes, assign and change PMs, run the month-end portfolio review.

B

Project Manager & QS Engineer

3 hours

Drive award conversion, maintain contract header, roster, calendar and milestones.

C

Tender Team

1.5 hours

Register tenders, record bids and results, capture honest win/loss reasons.

D

General Staff (view level)

45 minutes

Find your projects, read the status chip, know what on-hold and closed mean for daily work.



Everyone starts with Exercise 0: open project P014 and read its status, phase, PM and contract value.

One project, one controlled lifecycle

PRE-CONTRACT



DELIVERY & CLOSE-OUT



pause & resume

ACTIVE is the only working state

Tasks, drawings and purchase requisitions can only be created while a project is ACTIVE.

ON HOLD freezes new work

New tasks, documents and PRs are blocked; approvals already in progress still finish.

LOST & CANCELLED end the story

Both are read-only records kept for audit and for future tender pricing.

Twelve screens cover the whole module

01

Portfolio List

All your projects, filters, saved views

02

Creation Wizard

Seven steps, each one saves on its own

03

Tender Board

Pipeline columns with deadline countdown

04

Project Overview

Status, setup ring, contract, milestones

05

Conversion Checklist

The mobilisation cockpit

06

Team Roster

Who is on the project, and from when

07

Contract Header

Original value, revisions, current value

08

Milestones

Contractual dates with LD flags

09

Calendar Editor

Working pattern and site holidays

10

Numbering Rules

Document number patterns and locks

11

Project Settings

Defaults, workflow and notifications

12

Status Change

Reason, approver and consequences

THE CRITICAL PROCEDURE

From Letter of Award to live project in 10 working days

Four blocking items must be complete before the Director can activate the project. Until then, no tasks, drawings or purchase orders can be created.



Then: PM requests activation → Director approves → project turns ACTIVE and every module unlocks.

A counter on screen shows working days used against the 10-day target. If it stalls, the Director is alerted automatically.

Four things the system will never let you undo

1

Numbering locks on first use

Once the first drawing or RFI number is issued, its pattern is frozen forever. Confirm the preview with the PM before anything is issued.

2

Contract value is never edited

The original value is permanent. Every change is a revision with a reason and a reference. Current value = original + approved revisions.

3

One Project Manager, always

A project can never have zero or two PMs. Replacing a PM is a single swap action — never remove and re-add.

4

You cannot approve your own request

Whoever requests a status change or a contract revision cannot be the approver. This protects both the company and the individual.

Common mistakes and how to avoid them

What people do	What it costs	How to avoid it
Issuing a drawing before numbering is confirmed	The wrong pattern is locked permanently	PM confirms the preview in writing first
Removing a PM then adding a new one	The project is left with no PM and approvals stall	Always use the Change PM action
Asking IT to “fix” a contract value	Impossible by design — and it hides the change	Raise a contract revision with a reason
Vague tender loss reasons	Estimating learns nothing for the next bid	Use the reason code plus one honest sentence
Leaving conversion items to day nine	The 10-day target is missed and the Director is alerted	The PM checks the counter every day

One story runs through the whole training: Tower A

Trainees follow a single real-shaped project — P014 Tower A for client Mekong Development, USD 12.4 million lump sum — from first opportunity to first issued drawing. Roles are swapped so everyone sees both sides of an approval.

06 Jan	Register the tender	Deadline 20 Feb, 14:00 — with the time, not just the date
20 Feb	Record the bid	USD 12.4M submitted, transmittal reference captured
18 Mar	Record the win	Letter of Award entered — checklist opens automatically
19–24 Mar	Complete the four items	Contract, PM, WBS root, numbering — in the correct roles
26 Mar	Activate	Director approves — 6 working days used, target met
02 Apr	First drawing issued	P014-STR-DWG-B01-L01-001-R00 — numbering now locked

Eight actions, one line each



Register a tender

Board → Register → client, value, deadline with time



Record a win

Record Result → LOA reference → checklist opens



Convert an award

Contract → PM → WBS root → Numbering → Activate



Change the PM

Roster → Change PM → incoming person + effective time



Revise a contract

Header → New Revision → delta, reason, reference



Set numbering

Preview → PM confirms → then issue. It locks.



Put a project on hold

Status → reason citing the client letter → Director approves



Close a project

PC certificate → final account → handover → CLOSED

Assessment before system access is granted

20

quiz questions

Short written check covering statuses, locks, PM rules and approvals. Answer key included in the guide.

5

practical criteria

Judged on the live sandbox, not on theory.

Pass standard

Tender registration	Deadline entered with time and timezone; alerts visible on the board
Full award conversion	All four blocking items completed in the correct roles; project reaches ACTIVE
Contract revision	Revision carries a reason and reference; current value verified
Numbering discipline	Preview confirmed before issue; can explain the lock rule in own words
Status discipline	Understands separation of duties; reasons cite letters or certificates

Terms every user should recognise

LOA

Letter of Award — the client's formal award notice

Mobilisation

The award-to-site-start period, measured here in working days

Practical Completion

Works complete for use — starts the defect liability period

DLP

Defect Liability Period — the post-completion defect obligation

Final Account

The agreed final contract value — the gate to closing a project

Retention

Percentage withheld from payments as performance security

LD

Liquidated Damages — contractual delay damages, flagged on milestones

WBS

Work Breakdown Structure — the spine every record hangs from

IPC

Interim Payment Certificate — the monthly claim to the client

Separation of duties

The requester of a change can never be its approver

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

Three steps to go live

1

Train

Run the four tracks in the sandbox tenant using the Tower A story.

2

Assess

Quiz plus practical assessment; access granted on pass.

3

Adopt

First real project registered with the trainer present, then month-end portfolio review becomes routine.

A clean project setup is the cheapest risk control a construction company can buy.